

Then comes the chance of “bricking” your device. At the end of the day, you’ll be programming an EEPROM(Electrically Erasable Programmable Read-Only Memory) chip and there are a ton of things that can go wrong, which include frying your device. There is no coming back from such situations, however, good brands always have redundancies and performing a “dead-flash” (flashing a bricked device) repairs whatever damage might have been caused on a software level.

The offerings out there.

Rockbox

Rockbox has been kicking since 2001 and so far has proved to be a much better firmware than most stock firmware that devices come with these days. Rockbox offers support for over 30 codes, features gapless playback, volume normalisation, support of a variety of games and other applications. It also features a multi-lingual interface consisting of more than 30 languages.



What is the best part? The equaliser. The sheer level at which the equaliser can be adjusted makes audiophiles weak in the knees.

Since it has been around for a little over 11 years now, Rockbox supports a wide variety of players and new firmware are constantly being developed for PMPs as and when they hit the market.

Freemypod

A custom firmware solution for iPods without iOS. The project started where others like iPodLinux and Linux4Nano left off. The project is about reverse-engineering iPods so that developers can figure out a way to port custom firmware onto the PMPs.



whited00r

Also a custom firmware for iPod devices happens to be one of the most popular iOS modding communities. It is because whited00r is a jailbroken